

AXEL BREENS

Senior ICT Programme & Project Manager | Business Development & Operations Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior ICT Programme and Project Manager with 30+ years of experience leading large-scale, multimillion-euro technology and business transformation initiatives for national and international enterprises. Proven track record managing CAPEX programmes from €100K to €7M+, delivering measurable cost savings (including a €12M+ TCO reduction and a €33M 5-year CAPEX savings target), and leading cross-functional, multicultural teams of 10–15 professionals across Europe, India, and the US. Certified in Agile (SAFe 6 Agilist) and Scrum (CSM, CSPO), with deep expertise spanning both waterfall and agile delivery, PMO governance, business development, and people management. Recognized for aligning IT strategy with commercial objectives and consistently exceeding revenue and service-booking targets. Currently combining a senior programme management role at Telenet with independent business analysis and operations consultancy through ABR Consultancy.

CORE SKILLS

Programme & Project Management: Programme Governance | Waterfall & Agile/Scrum Delivery | PMO Leadership | Risk Management | Stakeholder Management | Vendor & Partner Transition Management | Budget & CAPEX Management (up to €7M+) | Regulatory Project Management | Change Management (ADKAR)

Leadership & People Management: Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Multicultural Team Management (10–15 FTE) | Hiring & Talent Development | Performance Management | Strategic Planning | Escalation Management | Coaching & Mentoring

Business Development & Client Engagement: Business Development | Account Management | Statement of Work (SoW) Development | Brand & Solution Positioning | Enterprise Sales Support | Client Relationship Management | Revenue & Booking Target Delivery

Technology & Domain Expertise: ICT Infrastructure & Operations | BSS/OSS Applications | Network Service Assurance | Predictive Maintenance | Telecom Product Introduction (FTTH, 5G, DTV) | Data Migration (large-scale IMSI/MSISDN) | System Decommissioning & Legacy Rationalization | Business Analysis | Excel & Power Query (Financial Reporting)

Tools: MS Project | MS Office (Advanced) | SharePoint | Microsoft Teams | Jira | Confluence

Certifications: SAFe 6 Agilist | Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) | Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO)

Languages: Dutch (Native) | English (C1 – Full Professional) | French (B2 – Professional) | German (B2 – Professional)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior ICT Programme Manager

Telenet | Belgium | March 2018 – Present

- Manage the full lifecycle of large-scale ICT and business programmes (CAPEX €100K–€7M+) using both waterfall and agile methodologies, ensuring governance through strategic alignment, structured reporting, and risk management.
- Serve as **End-to-End Delivery Lead for the Artemis programme** (€7M+ CAPEX), delivering ~45 products and capabilities for Telenet's B2B business unit on the new Origin ICT platform, spanning a 3+ year roadmap across 4 major TLNT releases; part of an 8-FTE governance team steering the programme.
- Led the **Popeye transition programme**, managing the migration of ~85 digital and data resources and ~35 legacy BSS/OSS applications to strategic partners Infosys and Cognizant, targeting €33M+ in CAPEX savings over 5 years.
- Directed the **Dependencies on Commercial Wholesale (DoC WHS)** programme, migrating ~7 million IMSI/MSISDN records to new inventory systems and decommissioning ~70 legacy applications, realizing €12M+ in TCO savings against a €1.85M CAPEX investment.
- Drove the **Network Service Assurance** initiative, introducing predictive-maintenance tooling on Telenet's Hybrid Fibre Coax and Fibre network to improve customer experience and financial performance.
- Managed regulatory programmes including 5G licensing preparation for BIPT, EU Data Act implementation, Lawful Intercept compliance, and EEC requirements for Card Stop and Number Portability.
- Led the **IC2N programme**, transitioning strategic partners Infosys and Cognizant to Telenet's Agile Way of Working (TAWOW), and renegotiated the **Netcracker 2021 contract** from a waterfall to an agile commercial model.

- Coordinated stakeholders across Legal, Business, Architecture, Development, Testing, Release Management, Sales, Infrastructure, and Operations, spanning teams in Belgium, India, the US, and multiple European countries.

Manager Operations Centre Infrastructure / Programme Manager – PMO

Econocom | Belgium | January 2016 – June 2017 (1 yr 6 mos)

- Directed a team of 10–15 internal and external SW/HW Engineers and Project Managers across Build and Run phases of major national and international customers.
- Managed operations centre infrastructure programmes and led PMO governance for ongoing client engagements.
- Applied structured programme management practices across infrastructure delivery projects.

Professional Services Manager Benelux & Nordics / Engagement Manager / Escalations Manager

NetApp | Belgium | May 2006 – May 2015 (8 yrs 11 mos)

- Directed teams of 10–15 internal and external Architects, TAMs, Consultants, and SW/HW Engineers across Build and Run phases of major national and international projects.
- Supervised 3–5 Project Managers delivering large-scale ICT infrastructure projects for enterprise clients including Daikin, ING, KBC Bank, Toyota, ASML, ABN AMRO, and the European Commission, Parliament, and Court of Auditors.
- Consistently met or exceeded annual service booking and revenue targets of **\$3.0 million**.
- Generated **€380K–€670K** annually in Professional Services bookings as Business Development/Engagement Manager, working closely with Enterprise Account Managers to position NetApp Professional Services with major Benelux accounts.
- Designed brand positioning strategy and customized service packages for enterprise clients; facilitated Statement of Work creation covering scope, timelines, deliverables, and acceptance criteria.
- Served as EMEA Geo Lead within NetApp's Global Engagement/Project Management community and organized Partner Academies to upskill technical partner resources.

Earlier Career

BDG Programme Manager, EMC (2003–2006) | **Coordinator of Project Managers / Project Manager**, MSP (2002–2003) | **Business Consultant / Project Manager**, Cronos (1999–2002) | **Product Manager**, Alcatel (1997–1999) | **Technical Project Leader / Software Designer**, Siemens (1992–1997)

EDUCATION

Master in Industrial Sciences / Industrial Engineer – Electronics (ing.) (*with distinction*)

Stedelijke Industriële Hogeschool Antwerpen (IHAM Paardenmarkt Antwerpen) | 1990

CERTIFICATIONS

- **SAFe 6 Agilist** – ID 28782527-6844, expired: 26 Apr 2024
- **Certified ScrumMaster (CSM)** – ID 000741796, expired: 06 Feb 2021
- **Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO)** – ID 1010752, expired: 06 Feb 2021

ADDITIONAL COMPETENCIES

Cross-functional collaboration, multicultural communication, technology integration, complex installation planning and staffing, performance metrics development, leadership and strategic vision.

Key clients served: Fabricom, ISS, Base, Daikin, Goodyear, VMM, Magotteaux, Toyota, ING, Ministry of Defense, European Commission, European Parliament, European Court of Auditors, KBC Bank, UCB Pharmaceutical, RBS, Rossel, UZ Gent, ASML, ABN AMRO, KPN Getronics, Belgacom, TomTom, Mobistar, De Post, FeDICT.